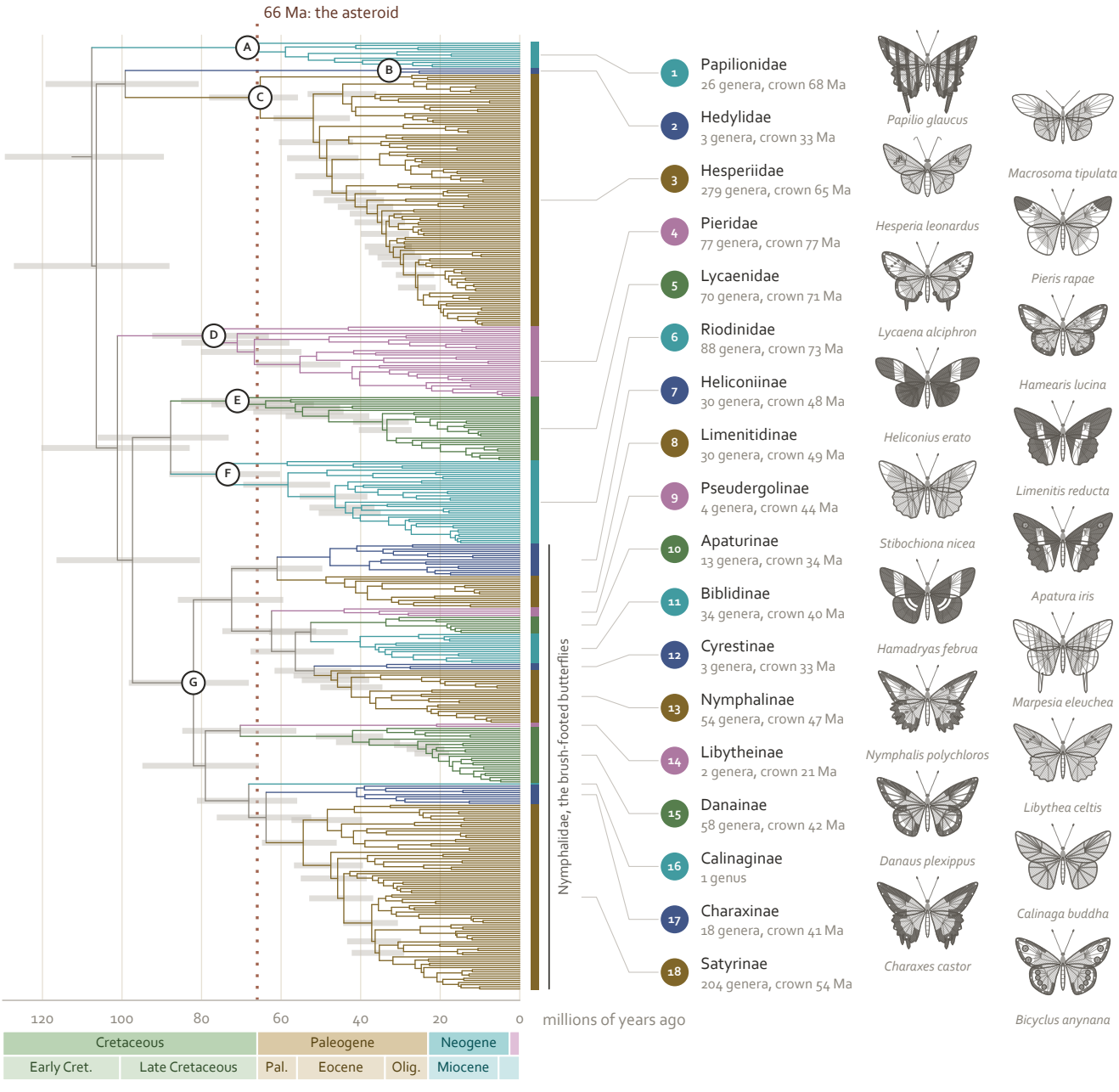
Every butterfly family had split off over 20 million years before the asteroid hit

Papilionoidea, 994 genera, 444 drawn · grey bars: 95 % interval of a node's age · crown: age of a group's last common ancestor



The seven families

A	Papilionidae	26 genera · split 108 Ma, crown 68
B	Hedylidae	3 genera · split 99 Ma, crown 33
C	Hesperiidae	279 genera · split 99 Ma, crown 65
D	Pieridae	77 genera · split 101 Ma, crown 77
E	Lycaenidae	70 genera · split 88 Ma, crown 71
F	Riodinidae	88 genera · split 88 Ma, crown 73
G	Nymphalidae	451 genera · split 97 Ma, crown 82

How to read it

branch colour and number: group

bar and row: the genera of that group

grey bar: 95 % interval of a node's age

lettered disc: a family's last common ancestor

dotted line: the asteroid, 66 Ma

drawings: pencil sketches of the group, not the genus

Chazot et al. (2019), Systematic Biology 68: 797–813; data doi:10.5061/dryad.fb88292 (CC0) · butterfly_tree.py · git dc52f5c